SPRINT 1 REVIEW

In sprint 1, our team focused on developing the initial pitch for our start-up idea. We identified the problem that many people struggle with limited vocabulary skills, which affects their ability to communicate effectively. At times, individuals also face challenges understanding uncommon words, while others overuse very common once, making their language repetitive. To address this, we proposed a solution that offers a modern, fun, and engaging approach to building vocabulary, rather than relying solely on traditional dictionaries.

The target audience for our project would be people that may have certain issues with general English. One of our targets would include people who are still in the process of learning English. This would include children going through the K-12 education and potentially some adults who may have English as their second language. Another target would be people who are fluent in the language but struggle to find the words to communicate properly. This would apply to people in, or have experienced, higher education where certain topics or ideas may be difficult to convey to their peers or coworkers. The project would help teach people vocabulary so that it may prevent some confusion that they potentially might run into in the future.

Our project provides a modern, fun, and interactive way to build vocabulary that goes beyond traditional methods like dictionaries or rote memorization. Instead of simply listing definitions repetitively, our solution incorporates engaging activities such as daily word challenges, interactive quizzes, and content-based examples that help users actually apply new words in real conversations. This makes learning practical, enjoyable, and consistent. What sets our project apart is the combination of personalization and gamification: users receive word suggestions tailored to their level and interests, while earning rewards for progress.

For feasibility, our team had to choose the right platform. We considered an android and desktop app, but we realized a web application was the perfect choice. A web app runs on any device with a browser, which makes it easy for classmates, teachers, and capable users to use it without the hassle of downloading or installing anything. It also allows us to develop and test faster within the semester timeline.

We thought carefully about technology and resources required for our project, we selected HTML, CSS and javaScript for the frontend. These are lightweight, universally supported and flexible enough to let us design a clean and responsive interface for showing daily words, favorites and quizzes. For the backend, we agreed on choosing Java with Spring boot framework, and MySQL database not only because it matches our skill set, but also because it is realistic to complete in a given time frame. We narrowed the project scope to 3 core features: delivering a daily word, allowing users to save favorites, and giving short quizzes. By focusing only on these, we reduce the risk of scope creep and make the project more manageable.

Every choice we made for platform, frameworks, and features was based on balancing our skills, available resources and the semester's time frame. Our team is made up of four members, and each of us brings specific skills that make this project possible. Andrew is the project head, keeping the team organized, sets priorities, and makes sure we stay on schedule. Robert on the other hand is our lead programmer and his main focus is the backend as he has strong experience with Java and HTML. Karan is handling the UI and UX design to create the layout, color scheme, and interactions so that our web is simple, modern and fun for users. Finally, Euphrata is our tester and documentation lead who ensures the system works correctly by testing features carefully and she also maintains clear documentation so our work is easy to follow and present. This is why we are confident the project is both technically feasible and achievable.

The challenges we faced are a couple. First off, all four of us had one to two ideas each, which gave us multiple options to choose from. But tackling the best one that would push us through this project was the first challenge we faced. After discussion, we were able to agree on focusing our energy on the vocabulary-building stat up (Daily-Logos).

Another challenge was time management. Since each of us has different class schedules and personal commitments, it was difficult to find common times to meet and move forward together. We addressed this by setting clear deadlines for when each section of the pitch should be ready and by dividing responsibilities so everyone could contribute on their own time, on the task that is due. Lastly, we faced some communication difficulties in the beginning, since we each had slightly different ideas of the final product. We solved this by creating a shared document to keep all our notes, features, and edits in one place, which helped us stay aligned